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North Eastern Region

As-is baseline



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Abbreviations

Term	Meaning
BAHS	Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics, the annual livestock statistics published by DAHD
CHC	Community Health Centre, the rural referral hospital serving about 80,000–120,000 people
DAHD	Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying, Government of India
DES	Directorate of Economics and Statistics of a state government
GSDP / NSDP	Gross / Net State Domestic Product: the value of goods and services produced in a state (net of depreciation for NSDP)
HLTF	High-Level Task Force; eight were set up in 2025 to plan specific sectors of the region's economy
MDoNER	Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region, Government of India
MoHFW	Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India
MoSPI / NSO	Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation / its National Statistics Office
NEC	North Eastern Council, the statutory regional planning body for the eight North Eastern states
NER	North Eastern Region: Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Sikkim and Tripura
NFHS-5	National Family Health Survey, fifth round (2019–21)
Vision 2047	NE Vision Plan 2047, the NEC's long-term development plan for the region
Lakh / crore	1 lakh = 100,000; 1 crore = 10 million; ₹1 lakh crore = ₹1 trillion

Introduction

India's North Eastern Region is planning for rapid growth over the next two decades. Those plans rest on baseline numbers: how large the economy is, how many people live in towns, how much food the region produces, and how well its health system is staffed. This report checks those baseline numbers against the latest official statistics, so that targets are set from an accurate starting point.

The region

The North Eastern Region (NER) comprises eight states. Together they cover about 2.62 lakh square kilometres, 7.9% of India's area, and had 45.8 million people at the 2011 Census, 3.8% of the national population. Almost all of the region's outer boundary is an international border, shared with Bangladesh, Bhutan, China, Myanmar and Nepal. Its only land link to the rest of India is the Siliguri Corridor in West Bengal, a strip about 22 km wide at its narrowest. Assam holds about two-thirds of the population and most of the economy; the hill states are smaller, more forested and more urbanised.

Table 1. The eight states of the North Eastern Region

State	Capital	Area (sq km)	Population, 2011 (lakh)	International borders
Arunachal Pradesh	Itanagar	83,743	13.84	Bhutan, China, Myanmar
Assam	Dispur	78,438	312.06	Bangladesh, Bhutan
Manipur	Imphal	22,327	28.56	Myanmar
Meghalaya	Shillong	22,429	29.67	Bangladesh
Mizoram	Aizawl	21,081	10.97	Bangladesh, Myanmar
Nagaland	Kohima	16,579	19.79	Myanmar
Sikkim	Gangtok	7,096	6.11	Bhutan, China, Nepal
Tripura	Agartala	10,486	36.74	Bangladesh
North Eastern Region		2,62,179	457.74	

Source: Census of India 2011. Manipur's population includes Census estimates for three subdivisions not fully enumerated.

Who plans for the region

Two national bodies work alongside the eight state governments. The North Eastern Council (NEC), set up by an Act of Parliament in 1971 and made the statutory regional planning body by an amendment in 2002, brings together the Governors and Chief Ministers of the eight states and is chaired by the Union Home Minister. The Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (MDoNER) funds and coordinates central programmes in the region. Under a standing policy, most central ministries also earmark at least 10% of their gross budgetary support for the North East.

The plans this report tests

High-Level Task Force reports. After its 72nd Plenary at Agartala on 21 December 2024, the NEC asked for sector plans to make the region a preferred destination for investment. MDoNER set up eight High-Level Task Forces (HLTFs) on 31 January 2025, each convened by a Chief Minister or, for sports, the Governor of Manipur. Their reports cover sports; agriculture and horticulture; logistics and connectivity; self-reliance in milk, eggs, fish and meat; tourism; handlooms and handicrafts; investment promotion; and a North East Economic Corridor. Each sets targets, most of them for 2030.

NE Vision Plan 2047. Prepared by the NEC Secretariat with NITI Aayog and the eight states, and published on the NEC website in July 2026, the Vision sets out how the region could match the national goal of a developed India by 2047. It aims for regional GSDP of about ₹200 lakh crore by 2047, up from ₹10.2 lakh crore in 2024-25, with every state above ₹30 lakh GSDP per person. It names the HLTF

reports as inputs.

Why a baseline check is needed

A target is only as good as its starting figure. If a plan assumes the region already produces 4% of national output when the official figure is under 3%, or that milk supply is a third higher than it is, the growth needed, the investment required and the progress later reported will all be wrong. The HLTF reports and the Vision were drafted by different teams at different times, and in several places they use different figures for the same indicator.

Scope and method

The report covers eleven indicators in five areas: the economy, urbanisation, tourism, food availability, and specialist doctors at rural health centres. For each indicator it records (1) the latest official figure and its reference year, (2) the figure used in the HLTF reports or the Vision, and (3) whether the two agree. Official figures come from the national statistical system: MoSPI, the Census of India, the Ministry of Tourism, DAHD, the Department of Fisheries and MoHFW, either directly or through the Reserve Bank of India and National Dairy Development Board tables that republish them. Where only an older year or a secondary report was available, the figure is labelled. Data were collected up to 11 October 2026.

How to read this report

Each indicator carries one of three flags:

Flag	Meaning
Mismatch	The planning document's figure differs materially from official data, or the topic is missing.
Check	The figures may differ only because of the reference year or definition; confirm before use.
Match	The planning document's figure agrees with official data.

The Summary gives the overall result. Sections 1 to 5 take each area in turn, with a chart and the underlying figures. Section 6 lists the revisions recommended for the planning documents. Indian number conventions are used throughout (see Abbreviations).

Summary

Six of the eleven indicators do not match official data, three need a check against the source year, and two match. Where the planning documents disagree with each other, the lower figure is the one closer to official data.

2.91%
NER share of India's GDP, 2022-23
Documents say ~4%

18.4%
Urban population, Census 2011
Documents use 21% and 28%

~98 g
Milk per person per day, 2023-24
India: 471 g

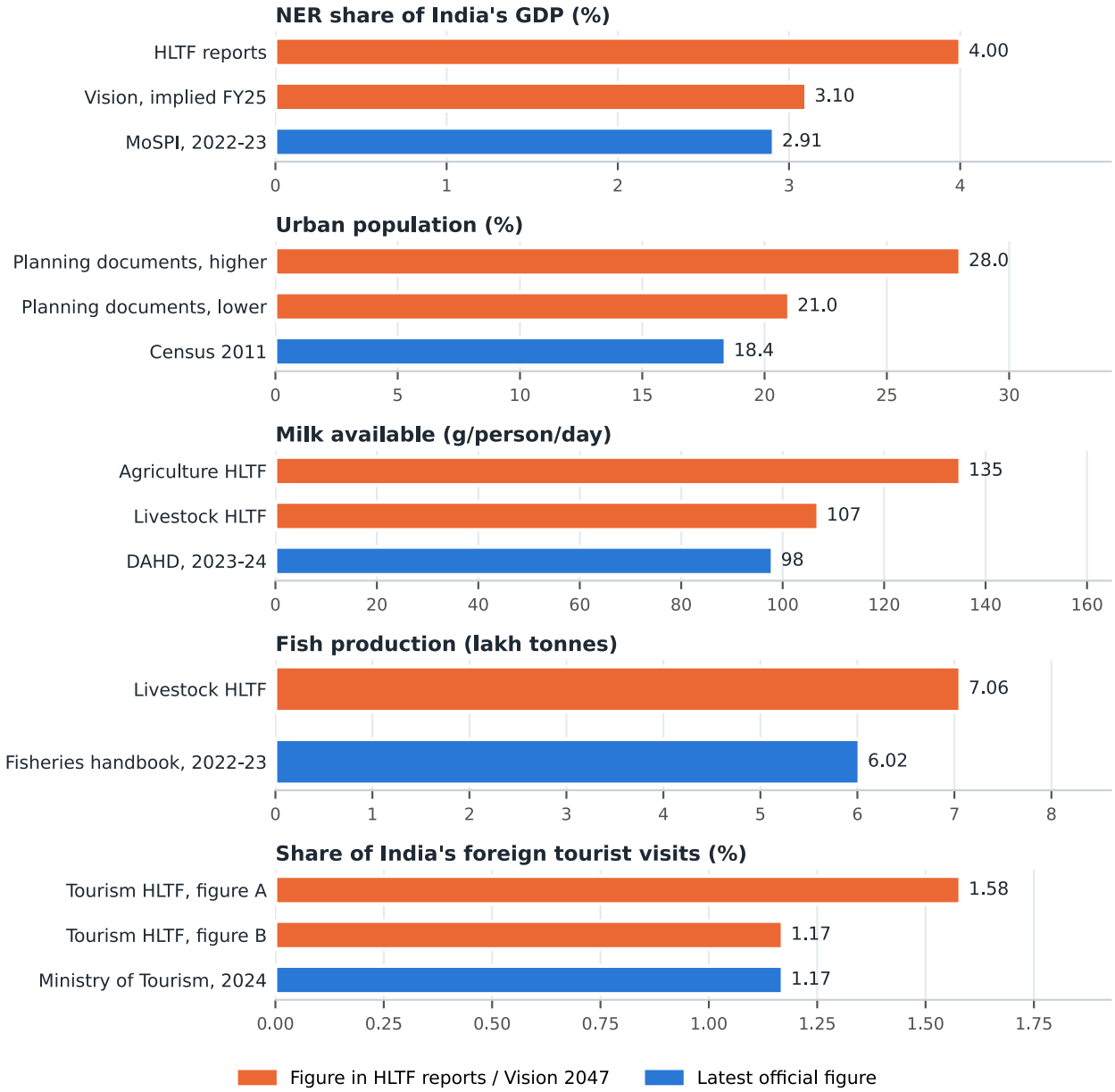
0.43%
Share of India's domestic tourist visits, 2024
Matches Tourism HLTF

79.9%
Shortfall of CHC specialists, India, 2023
75–97% in most NE states

Key findings

1. **The region's economy is smaller than the planning documents state.** The official share of national GDP is 2.91% (2022-23), not the ~4% quoted in the HLTF reports. The Vision 2047's own starting figure is consistent with official data.
2. **Urbanisation is overstated.** The last official figure is 18.4% (Census 2011); the planning documents use 21% and 28%. The Vision's 55%-by-2047 target therefore starts from a lower base than assumed.
3. **Milk supply is about a fifth of the national level.** The region has about 98 grams per person per day against India's 471. One HLTF uses 135 grams, a third too high.
4. **Tourism data are sound for arrivals but missing for output.** The region's share of domestic visits (0.43%) matches official data, but no state measures tourism's share of GSDP, so the HLTF's 10%-by-2030 target cannot be tracked.
5. **Rural specialist doctors are the largest unaddressed gap.** Four NE states have more than 90% of specialist posts at rural community health centres unfilled, and neither the HLTFs nor the Vision set a health baseline.

Figure 1. Figures used in the HLTFs and the Vision against the latest official figure



Sources: HLTF reports and NE Vision Plan 2047; MoSPI via MDoNER (Rajya Sabha, 13 March 2025); Census of India 2011; DAHD Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics; Handbook on Fisheries Statistics; India Tourism Data Compendium 2025. The two urbanisation figures appear in different planning documents.

Table 2. Baseline check, all indicators

Indicator	Latest official figure (year)	HLTF / Vision figure	Flag	Source to trust
NER share of India's GDP	2.91% (2022-23)	~4% (HLTFs); ~3.1% implied by the Vision's ₹10.2 lakh crore for FY25	**Mismatch**	MoSPI state and national accounts
Regional GSDP	Assam NSDP ₹5.59 lakh crore (2024-25); other states to 2023-24 only	₹10.2 lakh crore GSDP, FY25 (Vision)	**Check**	MoSPI / state DES; RBI Handbook
Urbanisation	18.4% (Census 2011)	21% and 28%	**Mismatch**	Census of India 2011
Domestic tourist visits	127.8 lakh, 0.43% of India (2024); ~151 lakh (2025)	0.43% (Tourism HLTF)	**Match**	Ministry of Tourism
Foreign tourist visits	2.44 lakh, 1.17% of India (2024)	1.58% and 1.17% (Tourism HLTF)	**Mismatch**	Ministry of Tourism
Tourism share of GSDP	No state estimate; India 5.00% (2022-23)	5% baseline, 10% by 2030 (HLTF)	**Check**	Tourism Satellite Account (national only)
Milk availability	~98 g/person/day (2023-24); India 471	107 g (Livestock HLTF); 135 g (Agriculture HLTF)	**Mismatch**	DAHD, Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics
Milk production	1,678 thousand tonnes (2023-24)	1,679 thousand tonnes	**Match**	DAHD, BAHS
Egg availability	India 106/person/yr (2024-25); NE states 7–74 (2019-20)	36/person/yr (Livestock HLTF)	**Check**	DAHD, BAHS 2025, Tables 53 and 60
Fish production	~6.0 lakh tonnes (2022-23)	7.06 lakh tonnes (Livestock HLTF)	**Mismatch**	Handbook on Fisheries Statistics
CHC specialist shortfall	India 79.9% (March 2023); NE states 75–97%	Not covered	**Mismatch**	MoHFW, Health Dynamics of India 2022-23

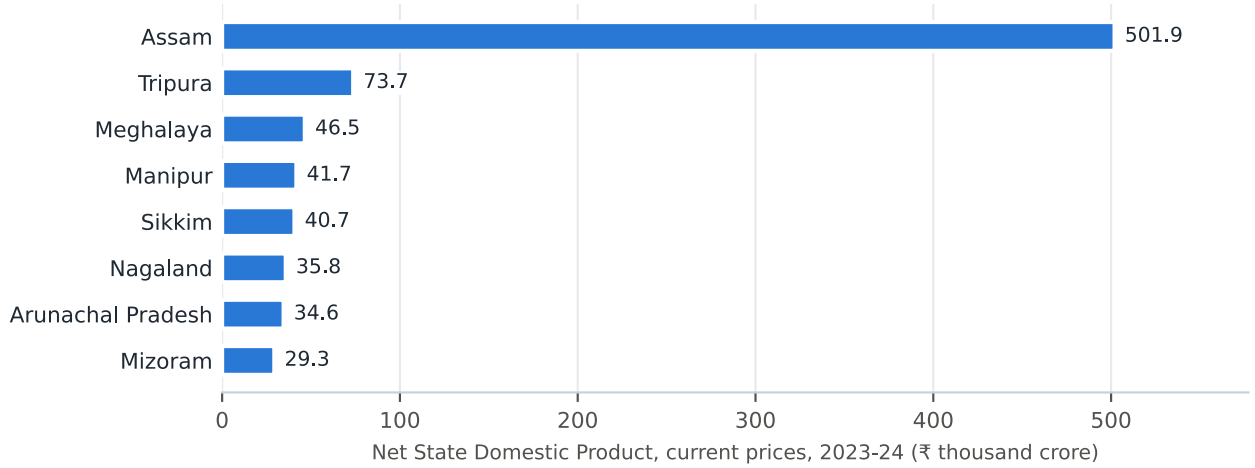
Flags as defined in the Introduction.

1. GSDP and share of national GDP

The region produces about 3% of India's GDP, not 4%. MDoNER told the Rajya Sabha on 13 March 2025, citing MoSPI, that the NE share rose from 2.66% in 2014-15 to 2.91% in 2022-23. The Vision's FY25 figure of ₹10.2 lakh crore is about 3.1% of national nominal GDP of ₹330.68 lakh crore (MoSPI provisional estimates, 2024-25), so the Vision's macro arithmetic is consistent with official data; the ~4% statement in the HLTFs is not.

Assam accounts for about 62% of the region's net state product (2023-24). Six states had not released 2024-25 estimates by August 2025, so a complete 2024-25 regional total cannot yet be built from official data.

Figure 2. Net State Domestic Product by state, 2023-24



Source: NSO via RBI Handbook of Statistics on Indian Economy, Table 5 (29 August 2025). Current prices, 2011-12 base.

Table 3. Net State Domestic Product, current prices (₹ crore)

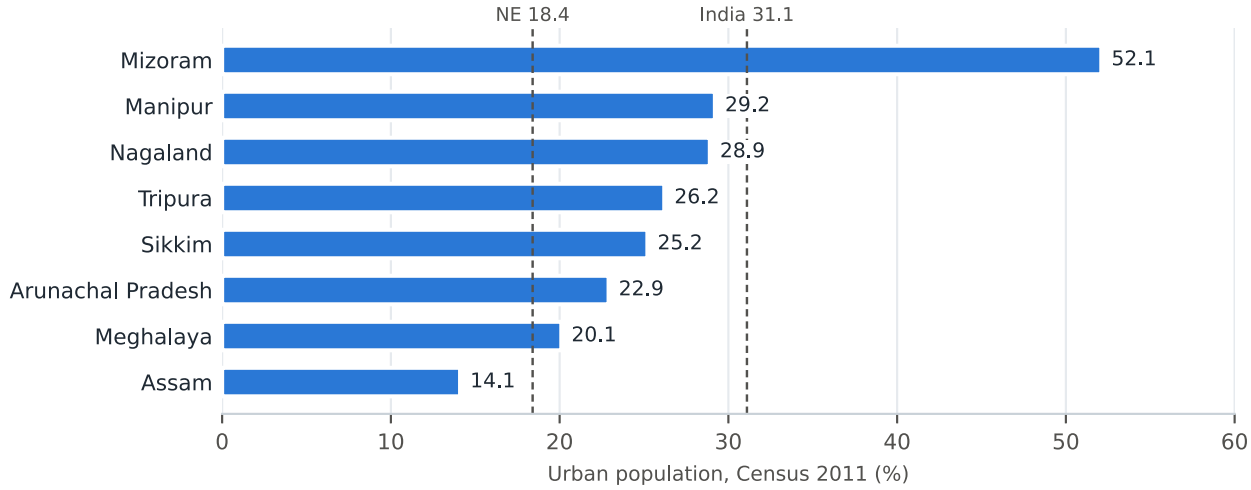
State	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25
Assam	4,24,003	5,01,933	5,58,930
Tripura	63,677	73,697	–
Meghalaya	41,679	46,480	51,338
Manipur	35,854	41,746	–
Sikkim	35,704	40,672	–
Nagaland	31,412	35,762	–
Arunachal Pradesh	31,029	34,551	–
Mizoram	26,537	29,336	–
NE total	6,89,895	8,04,177	–

NSDP is GSDP less depreciation, so it runs below the GSDP figures the Vision uses. '–' means not yet released.

2. Urbanisation

The last official figure is 18.4% urban (Census 2011), against 21% and 28% used in the planning documents. No later official count exists. The Vision's target of 55% urban by 2047 therefore starts from about 18%, and its ₹16.8 lakh crore urbanisation estimate should be checked against that base. Mizoram is far above the national level and Manipur is close to it; Assam, with most of the region's people, is the least urban.

Figure 3. Urban population by state, Census 2011



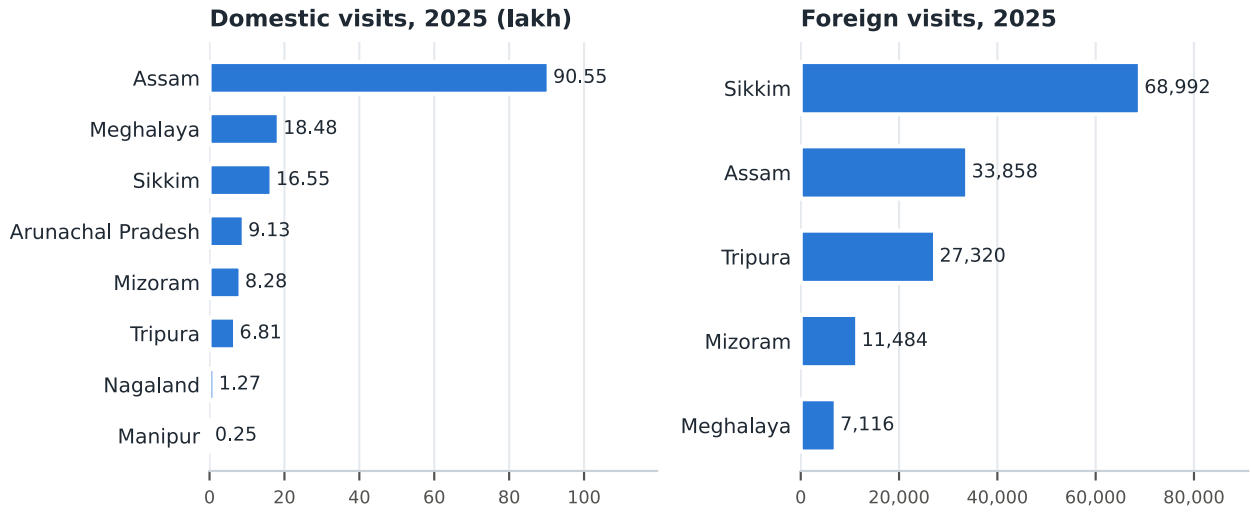
Source: Census of India 2011, Primary Census Abstract. Manipur excludes three subdivisions not fully enumerated; with estimates for them it is about 32.5%.

3. Tourist arrivals

The region received 127.8 lakh domestic and 2.44 lakh foreign tourist visits in 2024: 0.43% and 1.17% of India's totals. Domestic visits rose to about 151 lakh in 2025. The Tourism HLTF uses 0.43% correctly but quotes two foreign shares, 1.58% and 1.17%; 1.17% is the official one. Assam takes 60% of domestic visits; Sikkim takes the largest share of foreign visits.

No state measures tourism's share of GSDP. The HLTF's 5% baseline is the national Tourism Satellite Account figure (5.00% of GDP in 2022-23, of which 2.60% direct) applied to the region, so the 10%-by-2030 target cannot be tracked with current data.

Figure 4. Domestic and foreign tourist visits by state, 2025

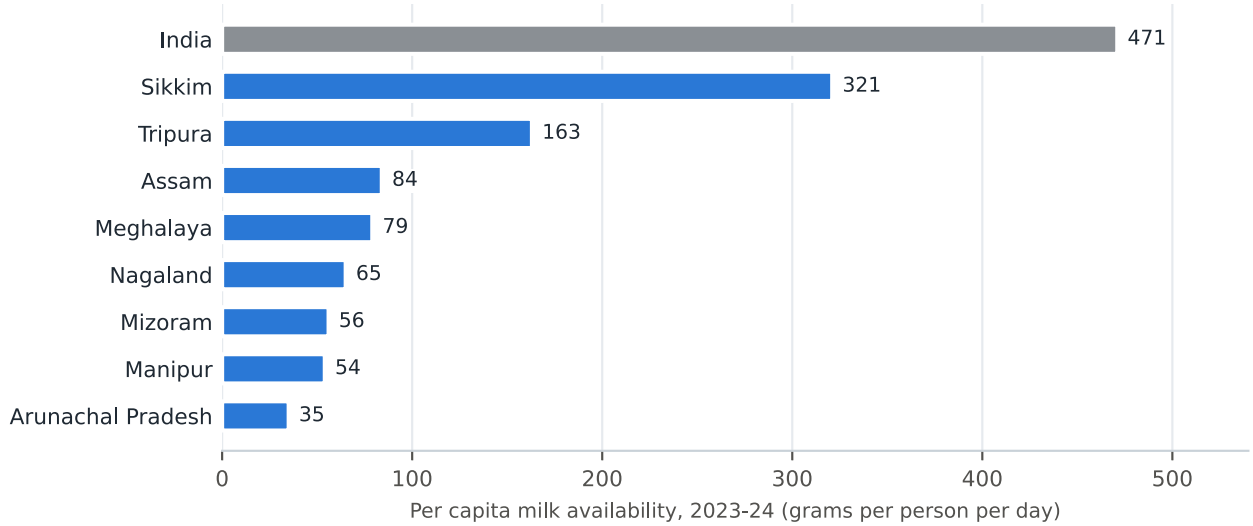


Source: Ministry of Tourism data given in reply to the Lok Sabha (August 2026), as reported by The Tribune and Business Today. Visits, not unique visitors. Foreign visits for Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland and Manipur were not reported in the sources.

4. Milk, egg, meat and fish availability

Milk availability in the region is about 98 grams per person per day, a fifth of the national 471 grams. The Livestock HLTF's 107 grams is close; the Agriculture HLTF's 135 grams overstates supply by about a third. Every NE state except Sikkim is below 165 grams. Regional output of 1,678 thousand tonnes in 2023-24 is 0.70% of India's, and meeting the HLTF's 2030 demand estimate would take 2.4 times that.

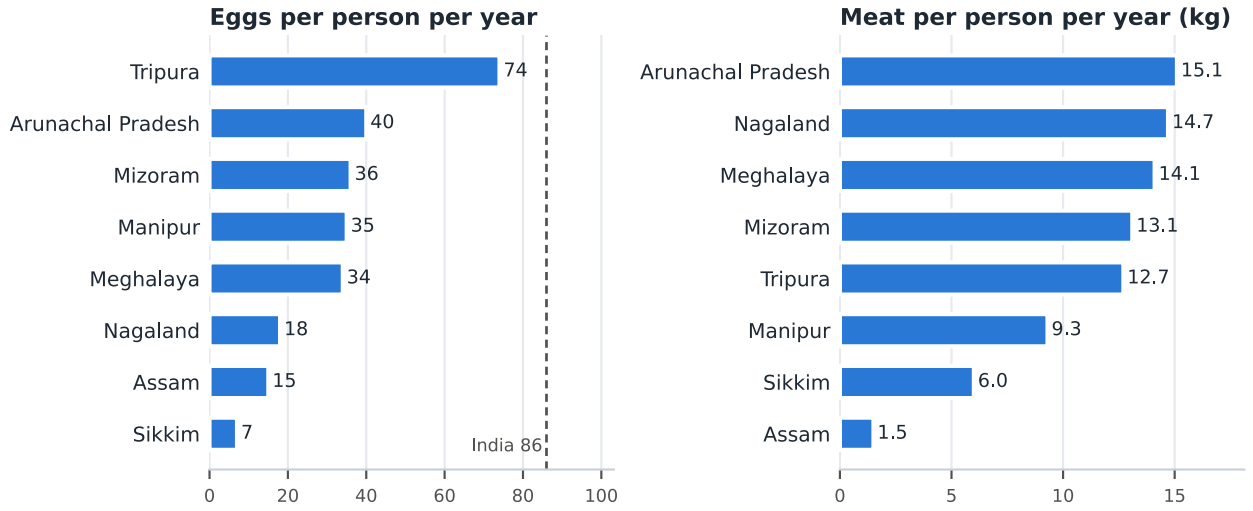
Figure 5. Per capita milk availability by state, 2023-24



Source: DAHD, Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics, via NDDB. India rose to 485 g in 2024-25; state 2024-25 figures are in BAHS 2025, Table 51. Arunachal Pradesh's figure follows a fall in recorded output from 46 to 20 thousand tonnes in 2023-24; confirm with DAHD.

Egg and meat figures by state are only available here for 2019-20. Egg availability ranged from 7 a year in Sikkim to 74 in Tripura, against 86 for India that year; the national figure has since risen to 106 (2024-25). The Livestock HLTF's regional figure of 36 eggs per person is consistent with the state pattern.

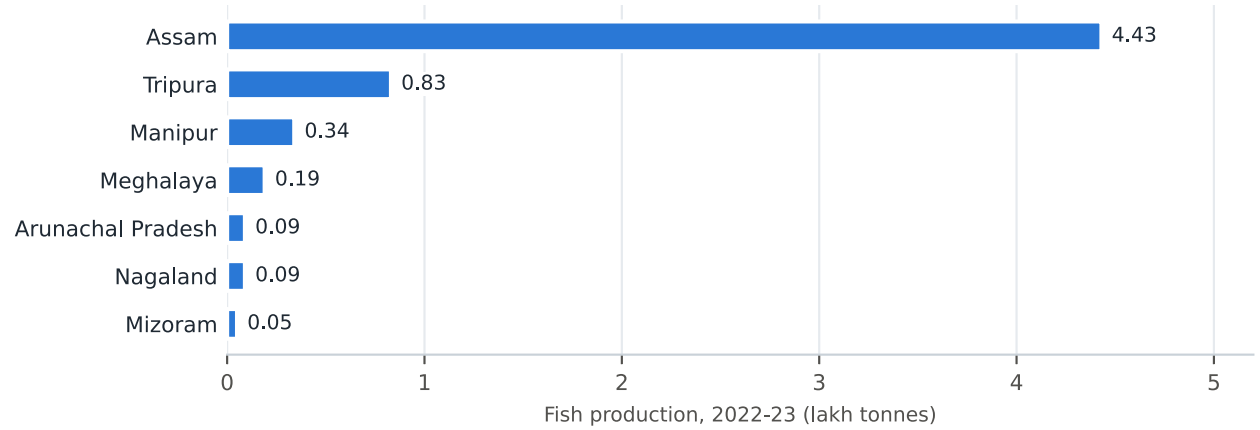
Figure 6. Eggs and meat available per person per year, by state, 2019-20



Source: Indian Journal of Animal Sciences (ICAR), computed by the authors from DAHD Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics. Assam's low meat figure reflects unrecorded slaughter. 2024-25 state data are in BAHS 2025, Tables 53, 60, 62 and 65.

The Handbook on Fisheries Statistics gives about 6.0 lakh tonnes of fish for 2022-23, against the Livestock HLTF's base of 7.06 lakh tonnes. Assam produces almost three-quarters of the total; its own statistical handbook reports 4.74 lakh tonnes for 2023-24, so the HLTF may be using a later year or a different series.

Figure 7. Fish production by state, 2022-23



Source: Department of Fisheries, Handbook on Fisheries Statistics, via RBI Handbook Table 98 and a PIB annexure. Sikkim not reported.

Table 4. Livestock and fisheries baseline

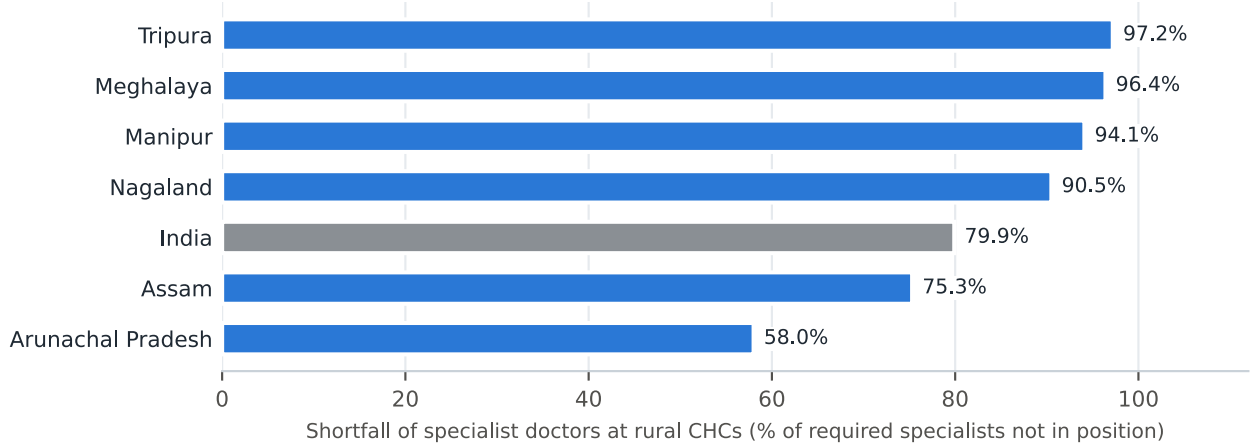
Item	Latest official figure (year)	HLTF figure	Note
Milk production	1,678 thousand tonnes (2023-24)	1,679 base; 3,417 target and 4,039 demand by 2030	Target falls short of demand
Eggs, India	1,49,110 lakh; 106 per person (2024-25)	India 103 per person	HLTF used an older year
Eggs, NE	7–74 per person by state (2019-20)	36 per person; 14,052 lakh produced	Update from BAHS 2025
Meat, India	105 lakh tonnes (2024-25)	–	
Meat, NE	1.5–15.1 kg per person by state (2019-20)	280 thousand tonnes; 559 by 2030	Update from BAHS 2025
Fish, NE	~6.0 lakh tonnes (2022-23)	7.06 base; 10.11 by 2030	Restate base year

Regional milk per capita uses a 2023-24 population of about 47 million (projection) and is approximate.

5. Specialist doctors at rural community health centres

Neither the HLTFs nor the Vision set a baseline for health delivery, which is the largest gap in either. Each community health centre (CHC) should have four specialists: a surgeon, a physician, an obstetrician-gynaecologist and a paediatrician. Nationally only 4,413 of the 21,964 required were in post in March 2023, a shortfall of 79.9%. Tripura, Meghalaya, Manipur and Nagaland have more than 90% of these posts unfilled.

Figure 8. Shortfall of specialist doctors at rural CHCs, by state



Sources: MoHFW Health Dynamics of India 2022-23 (India, March 2023); Health and Family Welfare Statistics via RBI Handbook Table 133 (Assam, Meghalaya, Manipur; latest year in the 2021 edition); MoHFW reply to the Lok Sabha, February 2021, as reported by EastMojo (Tripura, Nagaland, Arunachal Pradesh, Rural Health Statistics 2019-20). Mizoram and Sikkim not retrieved.

Table 5. Specialist doctors at rural CHCs

Area	Required	In position	Shortfall	Reference
India	21,964	4,413	79.9%	March 2023
Tripura	–	–	97.2%	Rural Health Statistics 2019-20
Meghalaya	112	4	96.4%	RBI Handbook 2021
Manipur	68	4	94.1%	RBI Handbook 2021
Nagaland	–	–	90.5%	Rural Health Statistics 2019-20
Assam	760	188	75.3%	RBI Handbook 2021
Arunachal Pradesh	–	–	about 58%	Rural Health Statistics 2019-20

The state rows predate the national figure; they will be replaced with the state tables in Health Dynamics of India 2022-23 in the next edition.

6. Recommended revisions to the planning baselines

#	Figure in the planning documents	Recommended baseline
1	NER share of GDP stated as ~4%	2.91% (MoSPI, 2022-23)
2	Urbanisation stated as 21% or 28%	18.4% (Census 2011) until the next census
3	Milk at 135 g/day (Agriculture HLTF)	~98 g/day (DAHD, 2023-24), or the latest DAHD year
4	Foreign tourist share stated as 1.58%	1.17% (Ministry of Tourism, 2024)
5	Fish base of 7.06 lakh tonnes, year unstated	6.0 lakh tonnes (2022-23) or state the year
6	No health baseline	Add CHC specialists and NFHS-5 nutrition indicators to the Vision's human resources chapter
7	Tourism share of GSDP not measurable	Ask state DES offices for a regional tourism satellite account

Limits

Three official tables were not available for this edition: state GSDP for 2024-25, state egg and meat figures for 2024-25 in BAHS 2025, and state CHC data in Health Dynamics of India 2022-23. Figures that rely on older years or secondary reports are labelled, and will be updated in the next edition.

Sources

Planning documents

Eight HLTF reports constituted after the 72nd NEC Plenary: Promotion of Sports; Agriculture and Horticulture; Logistics Cost, Infrastructure and Connectivity; Self-Reliance in Milk, Eggs, Fish and Meat; Tourism; Handlooms and Handicrafts; Investment Promotion Policy; North East Economic Corridor. NE Vision Plan 2047, Parts 1–4 (NEC Secretariat).

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